

History of General Aptitude in GATE

A source-safe explainer of the current GA pattern, the 2010-2026 archive reconstruction, and the important history nuance before 2010.

GA QUESTIONS

10

5 x 1 mark + 5 x 2 marks

GA MARKS

15common in every 2027 test
paper

2027 PAPERS

30

official test papers

MOST IMPORTANT CORRECTION

Do not say "GA entered GATE in 2010" as an absolute historical claim. The 1983 brochure already had a different common General Engineering Sciences / General Science paper. The official 2010 archive clearly shows the modern 10-question, 15-mark GA block.

What the official archive actually supports

Use this wording in the video. It is more accurate than saying all general/common aptitude content began in 2010.

1983



GATE 1983

The first GATE examination was in 1983. Its brochure describes a common Paper I: General Engineering Sciences for the Engineering Stream and General Science for the Science Stream, each with 40% weightage. This was a different structure from today's GA section.

2010



GATE 2010 ARCHIVE

Official 2010 papers show General Aptitude questions Q.56-Q.65: five 1-mark questions and five 2-mark questions. That is 10 GA questions carrying 15 marks - the format used for the historical series in this deck.

2027



GATE 2027

The current official pattern has 30 test papers. GA is common to all papers, with 10 questions carrying 15 marks out of 100.

Safe narration: "The modern 10-question, 15-mark GA block is clearly present in the official archive from 2010."

GATE 2027: current official GA pattern

These are direct facts from the IIT Madras GATE 2027 Question Paper Pattern and Information Brochure.

COMMON SECTION

GA

in every test paper

QUESTIONS

10

5 one-mark + 5 two-mark

MARKS

15

out of 100

TOTAL QUESTIONS

65

10 GA + 55 subject

DURATION

3 hours

standard duration

MARKING

Questions may be MCQ, MSQ or NAT. Wrong MCQ answers attract negative marking: 1/3 mark for a wrong 1-mark MCQ and 2/3 mark for a wrong 2-mark MCQ. There is no negative marking for MSQ or NAT. MSQ has no partial marking.

2027 PAPER UPDATE

GATE 2027 will be conducted for 30 test papers. Robotics & Automation (RA) is marked as New. The standalone GATE 2026 TF paper is converted to XE9 Textile Engineering & Fibre Science under Engineering Sciences (XE). The total remains 30.

Current GA share: 15 marks = 15% of the 100-mark GATE paper.

GATE 2026: 8 official sessions and 8 GA blocks

IIT Guwahati published eight exam sessions. Cross-checking official master papers shows session-level sharing of the GA block.

Session	Scheduled test papers
07 Feb FN	AG, ES, GG, IN, MA, MN, TF, XE, XL
07 Feb AN	AE, BT, CH, CY, GE, PH, XH
08 Feb FN	CS-1, ST
08 Feb AN	CS-2, EY, NM, PE
14 Feb FN	CE-1, EE, PI
14 Feb AN	BM, CE-2, ME, MT
15 Feb FN	EC
15 Feb AN	AR, DA

MASTER-PAPER CHECK

Same-session matches checked in official master papers:

AG = ES / MA
AE = BT
CS-1 = ST
CS-2 = PE
CE-1 = EE
ME = BM
EC = single-paper session
DA = AR

The eight session blocks are distinct.

Meaning for students

A test-paper count is not the same thing as a GA-set count.

What General Aptitude tests in GATE 2027

The official GA syllabus has four named sections. Use the official section names when teaching.

1. VERBAL APTITUDE

Basic English grammar; vocabulary, idioms and phrases in context; reading and comprehension; narrative sequencing.

2. QUANTITATIVE APTITUDE

Data interpretation using graphs, plots, maps and tables; ratios, percentages, powers, exponents, logarithms, permutations and combinations, series, mensuration, geometry, elementary statistics and probability.

3. ANALYTICAL APTITUDE

Logic: deduction and induction; analogy; numerical relations and reasoning.

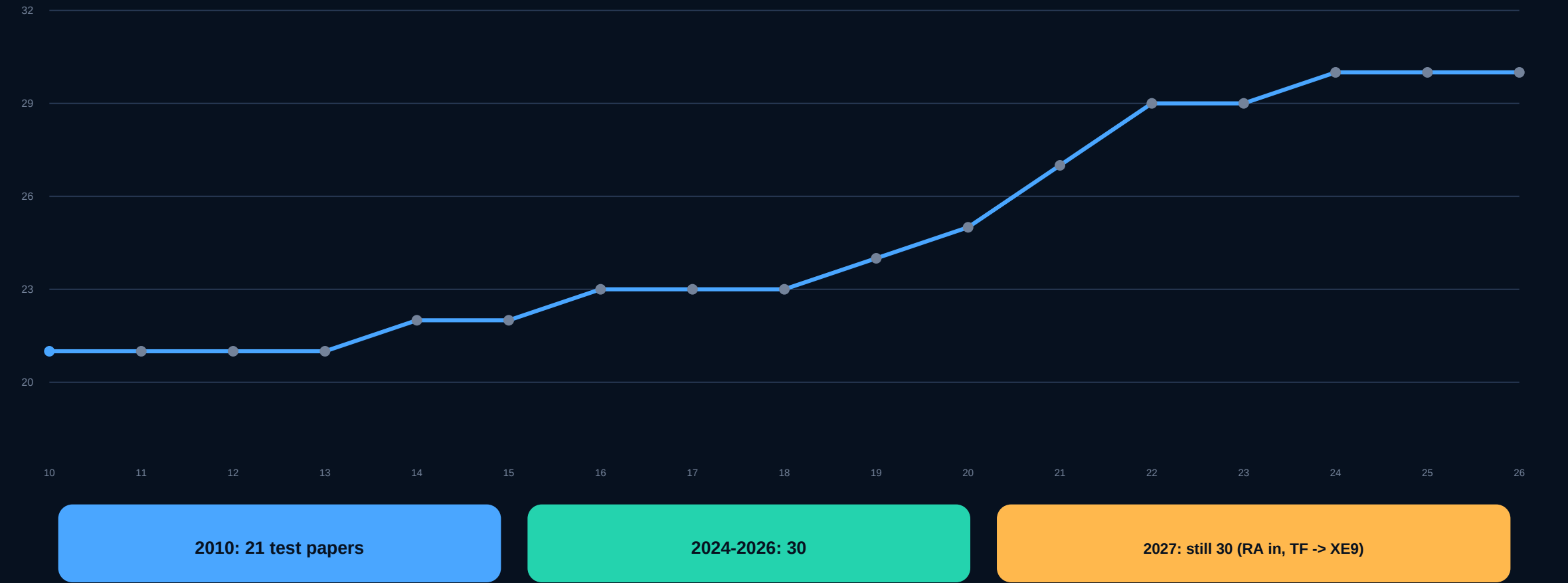
4. SPATIAL APTITUDE

Transformation of shapes: translation, rotation, scaling, mirroring, assembling and grouping; paper folding and cutting; patterns in two and three dimensions.

These four headings come directly from the official GATE 2027 GA syllabus.

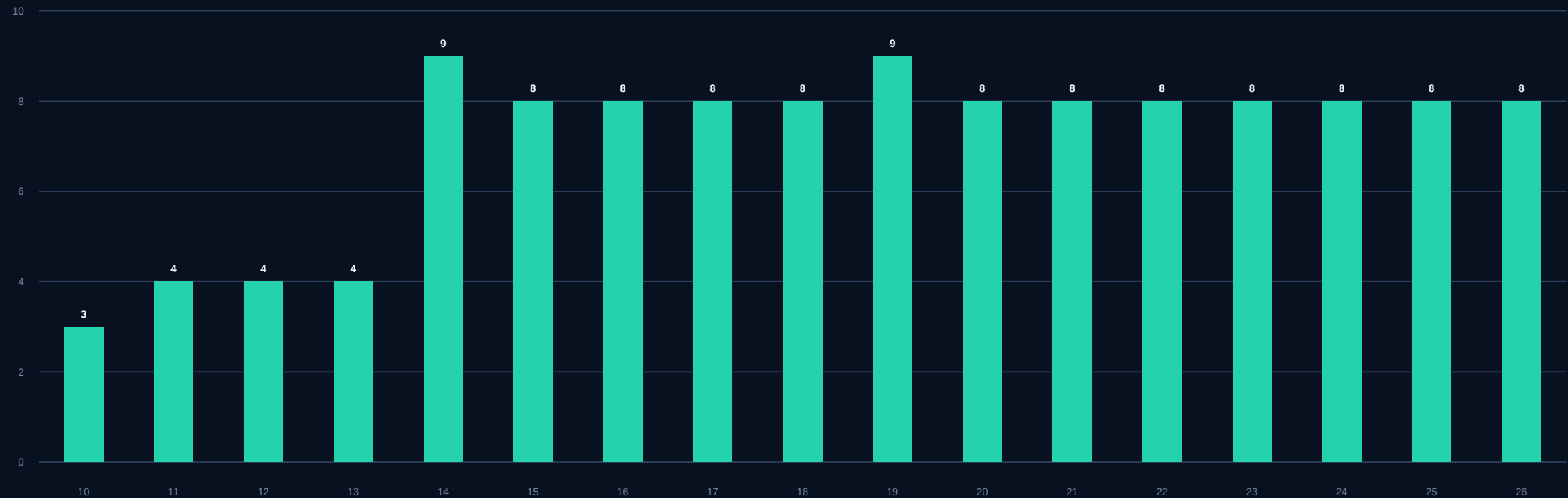
Archive-derived count: GATE test papers grew over time

Terminology corrected: use "test papers", not "branches". The count is derived from the official year-wise paper lists.



Reconstruction: GA blocks / sets by year (2010-2026)

This is derived data from official archived question papers and GA set labels/blocks. GATE does not publish this as an aggregate statistic.



Most years since 2015: 8 reconstructed blocks

2014 and 2019 reconstruction: 9 blocks

Test-paper count vs reconstructed GA blocks

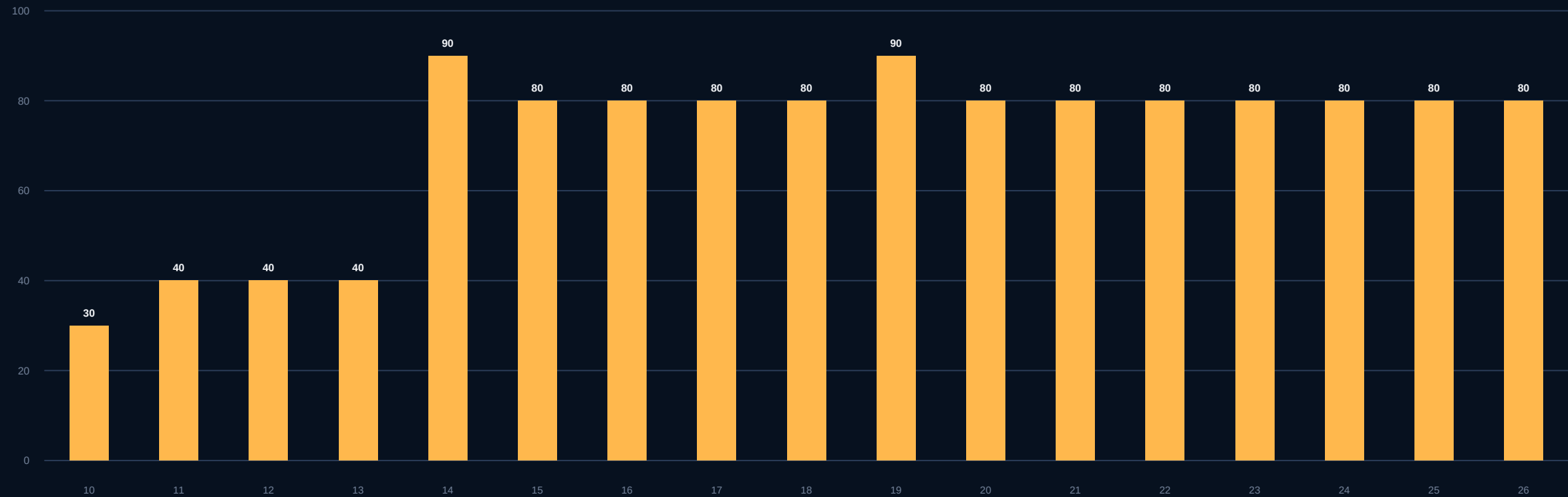
The two quantities are different: many scheduled test papers can use the same GA block.



Do not equate "30 test papers" with "30 unique GA papers".

GA PYQ practice volume from the reconstruction

Each archived GA block in this series contains 10 GA questions. "Question slots" means set count x 10, not globally unique questions.



2010-2026 reconstruction: 121 GA blocks = 1,210 GA question slots

Cross-year duplicate questions have not been deduplicated, so do not call these 1,210 globally unique questions.

Year-wise audit table

Use "Test papers" for the official paper count. The GA-block column remains clearly labeled as reconstructed.

Year	Test papers	GA blocks*	Q slots
2010	21	3	30
2011	21	4	40
2012	21	4	40
2013	21	4	40
2014	22	9	90
2015	22	8	80
2016	23	8	80
2017	23	8	80
2018	23	8	80

Year	Test papers	GA blocks*	Q slots
2019	24	9	90
2020	25	8	80
2021	27	8	80
2022	29	8	80
2023	29	8	80
2024	30	8	80
2025	30	8	80
2026	30	8	80

* GA blocks are reconstructed from official archived GA labels / question blocks.

Major standalone test-paper additions and the 2027 change

Names use current/official GATE terminology. This timeline is based on the year-wise official paper lists.

2014	EY	Ecology and Evolution
2016	PE	Petroleum Engineering
2019	ST	Statistics
2020	BM	Biomedical Engineering
2021	ES + XH	Environmental Science & Engineering + Humanities & Social Sciences
2022	GE + NM	Geomatics Engineering + Naval Architecture & Marine Engineering
2024	DA	Data Science & Artificial Intelligence
2027	RA	Robotics & Automation (New)

GATE 2027 change: TF is no longer a standalone test paper; it is converted to XE9 Textile Engineering & Fibre Science under XE. Total test papers remain 30.

Why GA deserves dedicated preparation

Keep official facts separate from GATEAndTech strategy. Avoid presenting coaching opinions as official GATE claims.

OFFICIAL FACT

15 marks

fixed GA share in every GATE 2027 paper

OFFICIAL FACT

10 questions

5 one-mark + 5 two-mark

OFFICIAL FACT

Common GA

same GA syllabus section across all papers

ARCHIVE VALUE

Many PYQs

GA blocks can be practiced across test papers

GATEAndTech STRATEGY

Because GA contributes 15 out of 100 marks and is common to all test papers, it is reasonable to prepare it as a dedicated scoring component rather than treating it as an optional extra.

DO NOT ATTRIBUTE TO GATE

Claims such as "GA is easier", "GA is more predictable", "lower syllabus", "high ROI", or "a few questions will improve rank quickly" are coaching judgments. If you use them, label them as your own strategy - not as official GATE facts.

Best factual message: GA is common to every paper and carries a fixed 15 marks.

Simple, source-safe video flow

A clean narration order that avoids overclaiming the history.

- 1 Start with today** GATE 2027: 30 test papers; GA is common, 10 questions, 15 marks.
- 2 Explain the history nuance** 1983 had a different common general paper. Official 2010 papers clearly show the modern 10-question, 15-mark GA block.
- 3 Show paper growth** Use "test papers", not "branches": the archive series rises from 21 in 2010 to 30 today.
- 4 Explain GA-set reconstruction** State clearly that the year-wise GA-block counts are derived from official archived papers, not an official aggregate statistic.
- 5 Use 2026 as the concrete example** Eight official sessions; master papers verify session-level GA sharing and eight distinct session blocks.
- 6 End with preparation value** Official fact first: GA is 15 marks. Then give any study advice explicitly as GATEAndTech strategy.

History + official pattern + verified sharing + clearly labeled reconstruction.

Verification notes: what is official vs reconstructed

This page is intentionally explicit so every claim in the deck has the right status.

DIRECT OFFICIAL FACTS

- GATE 2027: 30 test papers
- GA common to all papers, 15 marks
- 10 GA questions: $5 \times 1 + 5 \times 2$
- 65 total questions, 100 marks, 3 hours
- MCQ negative marking; no negative marking for MSQ/NAT
- RA is New; TF is converted to XE9
- Four GA syllabus sections

DERIVED FROM OFFICIAL ARCHIVES

- Year-wise test-paper count series
- Year-wise GA-block / set count series
- 121 reconstructed GA blocks for 2010-2026
- 1,210 question slots = 121×10

These are reproducible archive reconstructions, but they are not published by GATE as aggregate statistics.

PRIMARY SOURCES CHECKED

1. gate2027.iitm.ac.in/question_paper_pattern
2. gate2027.iitm.ac.in/exam_papers_and_syllabus
3. GATE2027-IB_v1.pdf and official GA syllabus PDF
4. gate2026.iitg.ac.in/examination-schedule.html and [QPs-answer-keys.html](https://gate2026.iitg.ac.in/QPs-answer-keys.html)
5. Official previous-paper archive (GATE sites) including 2010 papers
6. GATE 1983 Information Brochure in the official IISc GATE archive

Final takeaway

GA is common, fixed at 15 marks, and worth preparing.

For GATE 2027, General Aptitude is common to all 30 test papers and contains 10 questions carrying 15 marks. The official archive clearly shows the same 10-question, 15-mark GA structure in 2010 papers. Earlier GATE history is more nuanced: the 1983 examination already had a different common General Engineering Sciences / General Science paper.

SAY THIS

"The modern 10-question, 15-mark General Aptitude block is clearly present in the official GATE archive from 2010, and it remains a common 15-mark component in GATE 2027."

DO NOT SAY THIS

"GATE had no common/general aptitude content before 2010" or "GATE officially publishes 121 unique GA papers." Neither statement is supported by the official sources used in this audit.

Use official facts as facts. Label archive reconstructions as reconstructions.

GATEAndTech